

Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	29 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-6990
Project Name	Script-Controlled ACL - Restrict Record Access Based on Field Value
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas

This empathy map captures the needs, concerns, behaviours and expectations of ServiceNow users and administrators who work with record-level access. It helps the team understand how incorrect access can affect users and why field-based access control is needed.

Target User: ServiceNow user / administrator who needs secure access to records based on role and a specific field value.

THINK & FEEL • Wants only authorized records to be visible • Concerned about sensitive or restricted records • Needs clear and predictable permissions • Expects access to change when field values change	SEE • Records with different field values • Different roles and user groups • ACL configuration and access results • Allowed and denied records
HEAR • "I should only see records assigned to me." • Team members discuss access restrictions • Admins explain role-based permissions • Users report when a record is unexpectedly hidden	SAY & DO • Logs in using assigned role • Opens records relevant to their work • Checks whether access is permitted • Requests access when a record is restricted
PAIN • Unauthorized users may see restricted records • Too-broad role permissions • Confusing access errors • Manual checking of permissions	GAIN • Field-based record protection • Clear user/role setup • Controlled access • Easier security testing • Reduced unauthorized visibility

Key Insight: Users need access that is neither too open nor unnecessarily restrictive. The ACL should consider both the user's role and the required field value before granting record access.

Empathy Map - Script-Controlled ACL

Restrict Record Access Based on Field Value

THINK & FEEL I want secure record access. I worry about seeing records I should not see. I need predictable permissions.	SEE Users with different roles. Records with different field values. ACL results: allow or deny.	HEAR Access rules from administrators. Requests from team members. Reports about permission issues.
SAY & DO Checks records for work. Uses assigned roles. Requests access when needed.	PAIN Over-permissioned users. Restricted records hidden without clarity. Complex permission troubleshooting.	GAIN Field-based security. Correct access for authorized users. Clear user and role configuration.

User Need Identified

The user needs a simple and reliable access-control mechanism where the system checks the user's role and the record's field value before allowing access. This reduces unnecessary exposure of restricted records and makes access rules easier to test and demonstrate.

Expected User Experience

- Authorized user + matching field value -> access granted.
- Unauthorized user or non-matching field value -> access restricted.
- Different users can be tested to verify the ACL behaviour.

Reference: Empathy Map Canvas concept used in the provided template.